

Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker

Qatar's winter supply clock starts to tick

Extel - 2026

Global Fixed Income Research Survey

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Following the recent re-escalation of the Middle East conflict, LNG transit through the Strait of Hormuz has virtually halted. Based on Bloomberg ship-tracking data, the last observed transit occurred on 12 July, when a Qatari vessel exited the Strait (**Figure 1**). Since then, we have noted only one delivery to Kuwait. Qatar loadings, however, appear to be continuing, albeit at a reduced pace. We estimate that Qatar loadings are currently averaging around 22% on a 7-day moving-average basis, compared to 30% earlier in July. However, most of these loaded cargoes are effectively functioning as floating storage, given that Hormuz is once again effectively closed and intra-Gulf deliveries remain limited (**Figure 2**).

The key question now is how quickly the current escalation can be resolved, and whether Qatar may be forced to shut down production again. There are many moving parts in these estimates. At the onset of the conflict, we estimated that Qatar had roughly five days of storage capacity when operating at full liquefaction capacity. Mathematically, this could extend to 20-25 days if Qatar is running at about 20% utilization, with floating storage providing an additional cushion. With no confirmed transits via Hormuz over the past week, we still count 23 LNG vessels in the Gulf (**Table 1**). However, how many of these vessels are already loaded, and how many are available for Qatar Energy to load additional cargoes, remains unclear. Furthermore, onshore operational complexities, including the processing and storage requirements for rich versus lean LNG, impose further limitations.

At current price levels of around €60/MWh this morning, we believe the market is beginning to price in a risk premium around Qatar winter volumes. This would mark a sharp sea-change compared to the prevailing market view prior to the escalation, which appeared to assume that Qatar would be fully back on line by winter and that Europe could source additional spot LNG cargoes as needed, rather than relying on storage as in the past. That expectation had helped keep a lid on TTF prices. However, the longer the current circumstances persist, the more that assumption will be tested, and prices could move sharply higher.

We think Qatar can reach “tank-full” within the next 2-3 weeks, potentially forcing production to shut down again or drop materially. There is, however, a significant margin of error around this timing, given the uncertainties and complexities over onshore/offshore storage availability, as described above. From the point of any shutdown, a full restart could take another 2-3 months, by which time we would already be in the Northern Hemisphere winter.

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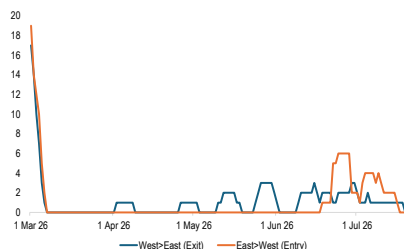
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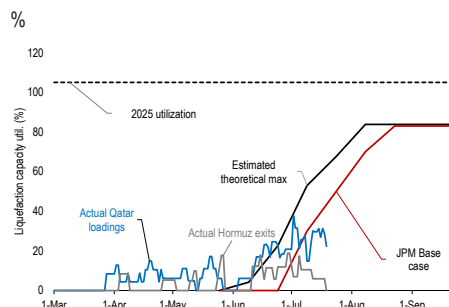
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Figure 1: LNG vessels traffic in Strait of Hormuz
n of vessels, 7 day moving sum



Latest forecasts from [Global LNG Analyzer: Again on Qatari restarts](#),
21 April 2026
Source: J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 2: Actual ramp up speed of Qatar LNG liquefaction capacity

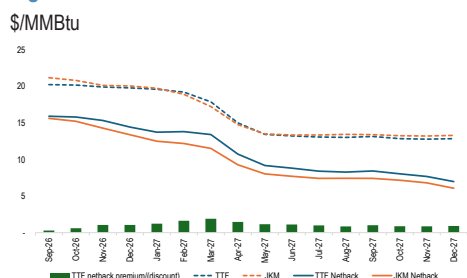


Actual loadings and Hormuz exits are 7-day moving averages. Hormuz exits are based on observed number of crossings and average Qatari cargo size, includes all exits (i.e. ballast and UAE loaded cargoes).
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., Wood Mackenzie, J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

US LNG remains Asia bound

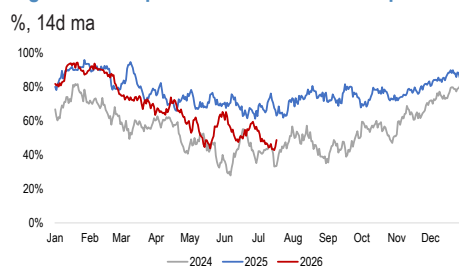
Meanwhile, the competitiveness of the US spot cargoes remains largely unchanged. Most of the cargoes are still pointing towards Asian destinations, as JKM/TTF netbacks remain largely flat for the next month or two (**Figure 3 & Figure 4**). A sizeable TTF netback premium only emerges from November, implying higher reliance on LNG imports in winter, as described above. However, this might prove a very risky strategy for Europe with historically low storage levels, rising uncertainties around Qatar supply and the usual winter weather risks not only in Europe, but also in the US and Asia.

Figure 3: JKM/TTF netbacks



Netbacks based on USGC origin cargoes, assuming current West of Suez shipping spot rates and estimated other costs (insurance, port fees, etc.)
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 4: Europe share in USGC LNG exports



Based on loading dates, in transit volumes based on the current location of the vessels
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Weekly export/import trends

During the week of July 13-19, LNG deliveries increased by a healthy 2.1 Bcm week-over-week (+0.8 Bcm YoY). This was driven by a 1.5 Bcm WoW increase in deliveries to China (+1 Bcm YoY), followed by increases in other Asian importers: JKM (+0.3 Bcm WoW, +0.6 Bcm YoY), India/Taiwan (each +0.2 Bcm WoW, flat YoY). Accordingly, deliveries to Europe decreased over the week by 0.6 Bcm WoW (-1.2 Bcm YoY), and remain well below seasonal norms and levels required to correct the storage path (**Figure 5**).

With regard to LNG exports, in line with our expectations, the global LNG supply starts to show signs of slowdown. Overall weekly loadings marginally decreased by 0.8 Bcm WoW (-1.2 Bcm YoY), led by the US (-0.2 Bcm WoW) and rest of North America (-0.3 Bcm WoW) (**Figure 6**).

Figure 5: Change in LNG imports

Bcm, 13-19 July 2026

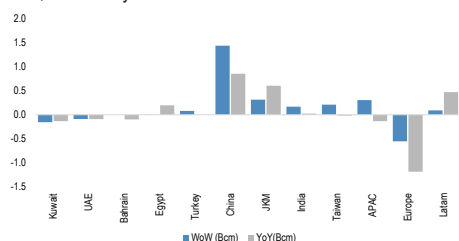
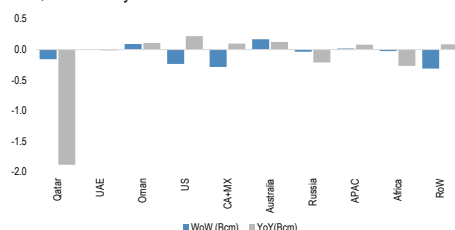


Figure 6: Change in LNG exports (loadings)

Bcm, 13-19 July 2026



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Weekly loadings from recent projects

Loadings from existing projects, which are expected to increase supply year-over-year, remained broadly flat (**Figure 7**). Arctic LNG 2 loaded one cargo, reaching 44% utilization on a four-week rolling average basis, similar to the May peak level. LNG Canada loadings declined by one cargo week-over-week, leading to utilization declining to an 83% rate. In the US, Golden Pass and Plaquemines loaded one more cargo compared to the week before, while elsewhere loadings remained broadly unchanged (**Figure 12-Figure 24**).

Figure 7: LNG supply decomposition (2025-27)

Bcm

Country	Project	JPM start date	Capacity (Bcm/Year)	2025 Output (A)	2026 Output (F)	2027 Output (F)	2025 y/y (A)	2026 y/y (F)	2027 y/y (F)	2026 YTD y/y (A)*	% 2026 (A)*
Projects started in 2025											
US	Plaquemines LNG Phase 1 + 2	Jan-25	38.4	22.8	37.7	37.7	22.8	14.8	-	11.0	74%
Canada	LNG Canada	Jul-25	19.2	2.7	15.3	16.2	2.7	12.5	0.9	7.5	60%
US	Corpus Christi LNG Stage 3	Jan-25	16.4	2.9	11.0	15.6	2.9	8.1	4.6	4.2	52%
Russia	Arctic LNG 2 - Train 1 + 2	Jul-25	18.1	1.6	5.9	6.0	1.6	4.3	0.1	2.6	61%
Mauritania/Senegal	Tortue Phase 1 FLNG	Apr-25	3.3	1.8	3.4	3.4	1.8	1.6	-	1.4	90%
Projects starting in 2026											
Australia	Darwin Restart	Jan-26	5.1	-	2.3	3.5	-	2.3	1.3	0.7	31%
Congo	Nguya FLNG	Mar-26	3.3	-	1.9	2.6	-	1.9	0.7	0.6	31%
US	Golden Pass Export - Train 1	Apr-26	8.3	-	4.2	7.8	-	4.2	3.7	0.3	7%
Mexico	Costa Azul Phase 1	Sep-26	4.5	-	1.0	3.6	-	1.0	2.5	-	-
Australia	Pluto Expansion	Nov-26	6.9	-	0.7	5.8	-	0.7	5.1	-	-
Projects starting in 2027											
US	Golden Pass Export - Train 2	Feb-27	8.3	-	-	4.6	-	-	4.6	-	-
US	CP2 LNG Phase 1 + 2	Sep-27	39.7	-	-	4.2	-	-	4.2	-	-
US	Port Arthur LNG - Phase 1 - Train 1	Dec-27	8.9	-	-	0.1	-	-	0.1	-	-
Nigeria	NLNG Seven - Train 1	Jul-27	5.3	-	-	1.3	-	-	1.3	-	-
Indonesia	Genting FLNG	Jul-27	1.6	-	-	0.4	-	-	0.4	-	-
Qatar	Qatar North Field East - Train 1	Sep-27	11.0	-	-	1.7	-	-	1.7	-	-
Gabon	Gabon FLNG	Sep-27	1.0	-	-	0.2	-	-	0.2	-	-
Mexico	Altamira FLNG 1	Dec-27	1.9	-	-	0.0	-	-	0.0	-	-
Total 2025 projects				32.0	73.3	78.9	32.0	41.3	5.6	26.8	65%
Total 2026 projects				-	10.1	23.4	-	10.1	13.3	1.6	16%
Total 2027 projects				-	-	12.5	-	-	12.5	-	-
Total 2025-27 projects				32.0	83.4	114.9	32.0	51.4	31.5	28.3	55%
Qatar	Existing 14 trains			112.6	61.6	87.3	4.7	-51.0	25.7		
UAE	Existing 2 trains			6.3	4.9	6.7	-1.2	-1.4	1.8		
Rest of the world				448.0	451.6	451.6	2.3	3.6	-		
Grand total				598.9	601.5	660.5	37.8	2.6	59.0		

Corpus Christi LNG stage 3 capacity includes potential de-bottlenecking (2mtpa across 9 mid-scale trains). CP2 capacity excludes bolt-on 10mtpa, which is expected in 2028

(A)= Actual, (F) =Forecast, * as of June 2026

Source: Wood Mackenzie, company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Table 1: LNG vessels in the Persian Gulf

As of 20 July 2026

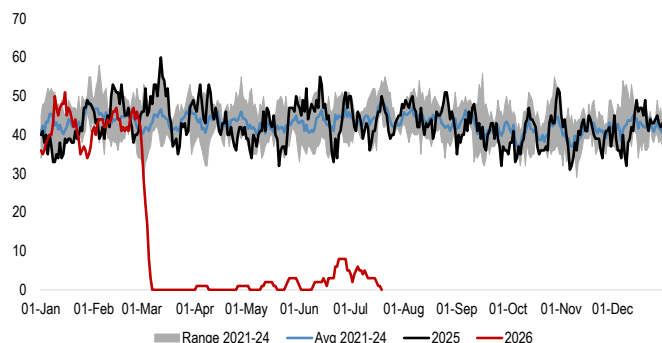
Vessel Name	Beneficial Owner	DWT	Insurer	Insurance country	Comment
Al Samriya	Qatar Energy	154,900	Gard	Norway	
Mekaines	Qatar Energy	143,309	Gard	Norway	
Al Dafna	Qatar Energy	130,157	Britannia P&I	UK	
Al Sadd	Qatar Energy	121,913	NorthStandard	UK	
Umm Al Amad	Qatar Energy	121,730	Japan P&I Club	Japan	
Al Gharrafa	Qatar Energy	113,861	Gard	Norway	
Mesaiameer	Qatar Energy	113,852	Britannia P&I	UK	Last seen July 19
Al Kharaitiyat	Qatar Energy	113,845	NorthStandard	UK	
Al Sahla	Qatar Energy	113,715	UK P&I	UK	
Al Gattara	Qatar Energy	113,590	Gard	Norway	
Al Shamal	Qatar Energy	109,662	NorthStandard	UK	
Al Kharsaah	Qatar Energy	109,484	NorthStandard	UK	
Milaha Qatar	Qatar Energy	77,803	NorthStandard	UK	
Al Rayyan	Qatar Energy	72,430	Britannia P&I	UK	
Mubaraz	ADNOC	72,950	NorthStandard	UK	Last seen July 16
Seapeak Bahrain	Seapeak	95,289	NorthStandard	UK	Last seen July 19
Al Areesh	Seapeak	90,617	Skuld	Norway	
Al Marrouna	Seapeak	81,936	Skuld	Norway	
Gaslog Shanghai	China Development Bank	82,104	West of England	UK	
Gaslog Skagen	China Development Bank	81,847	West of England	UK	
Qtaifan	ICBC	88,039	Gard	Norway	
Wadi Al Sail	Other/unknown	93,124	Skuld	Norway	
Shandong Redwood	Other/unknown	79,084	Gard	Norway	

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

LNG shipments through major maritime routes

Figure 8: LNG vessels through the Strait of Hormuz

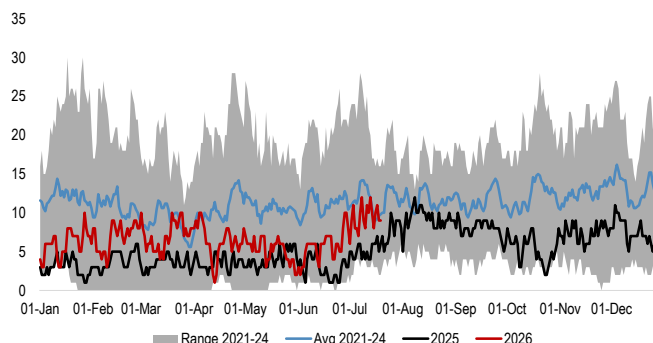
n of vessels, 7 day moving sum



Includes all passages by laden and ballast vessels
 Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 9: LNG vessels through the Suez Canal

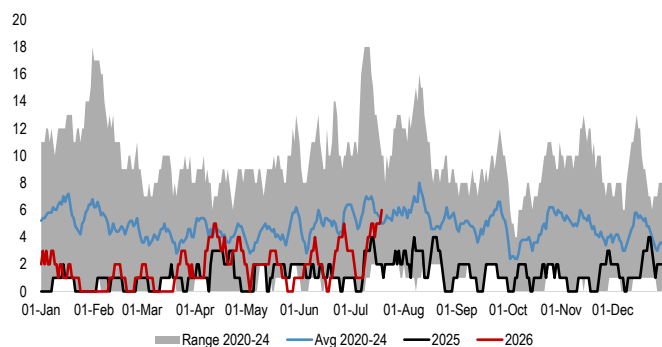
n of vessels, 7 day moving sum



Includes all passages by laden and ballast vessels
 Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 10: LNG vessels through the Panama Canal

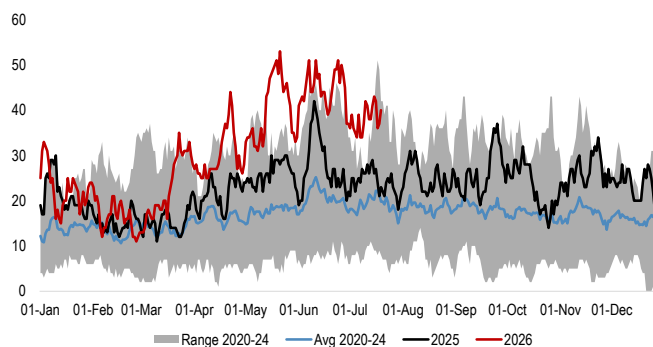
n of vessels, 7 day moving sum



Includes all passages by laden and ballast vessels
 Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 11: LNG vessels through the Cape of Good Hope

n of vessels, 7 day moving sum

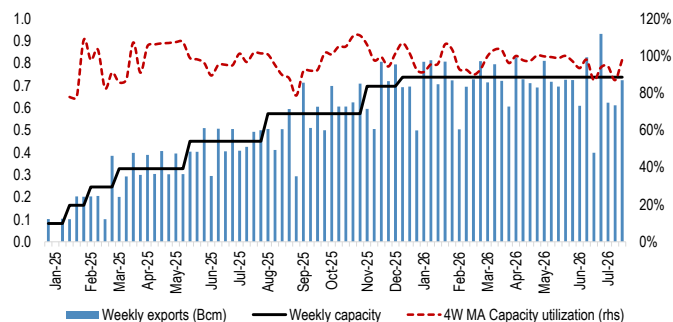


Includes all passages by laden and ballast vessels
 Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

New supply tracker

Figure 12: Plaquemines weekly exports and capacity utilisation

LHS: Bcm, RHS: %

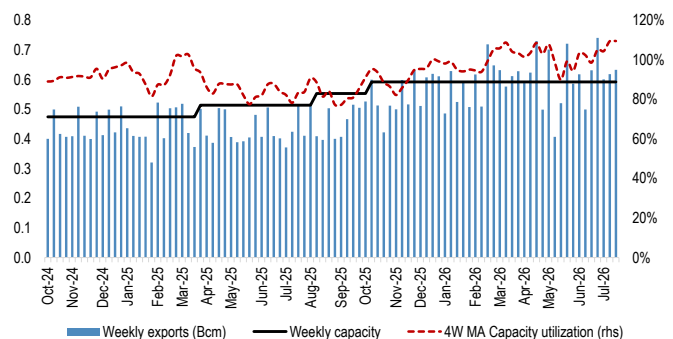


Assumed capacity across 36 trains 28 mtpa (38.4 Bcm/year)

Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 14: CCL 3 weekly exports and capacity utilisation

LHS: Bcm, RHS: %

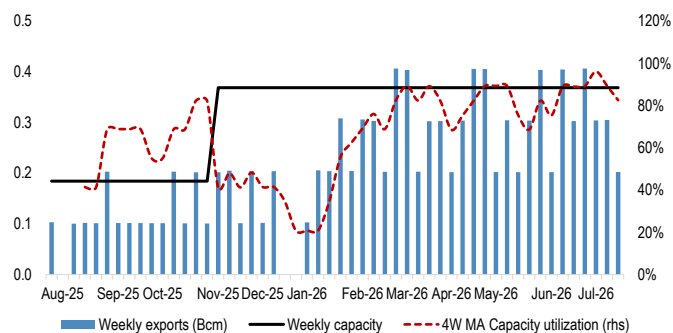


Assumed capacities: 18 mtpa (24.7 Bcm/year) for existing three large scale trains, 10.4 mtpa (14.3 Bcm/year) for seven new mid scale trains (currently 3 in operation), 2mtpa debottlenecking across 9 mid-scale trains

Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 16: LNG Canada weekly exports and capacity utilisation

LHS: Bcm, RHS: %

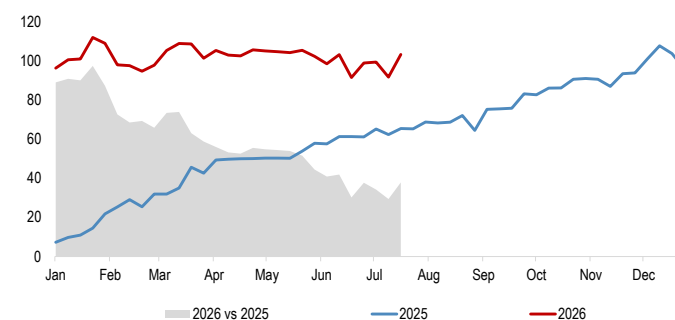


Assumed capacity 7mtpa (9.6 Bcm/year) per train

Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 13: Plaquemines seasonal exports

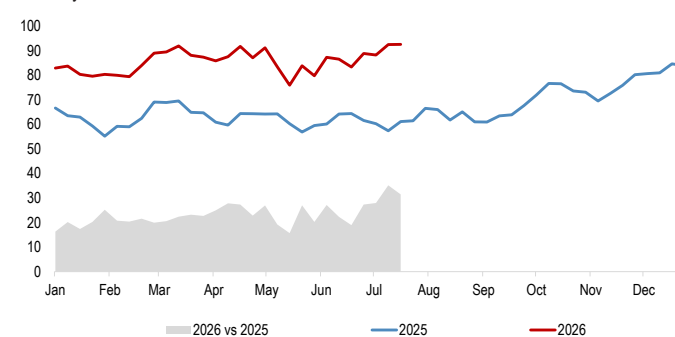
Mcm/day, 4w MA



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 15: CCL 3 seasonal exports

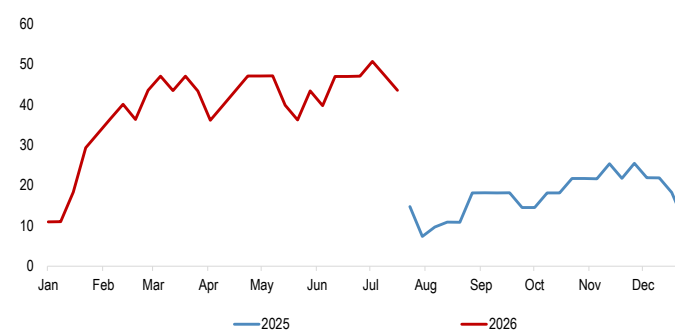
Mcm/day, 4w MA



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 17: LNG Canada seasonal exports

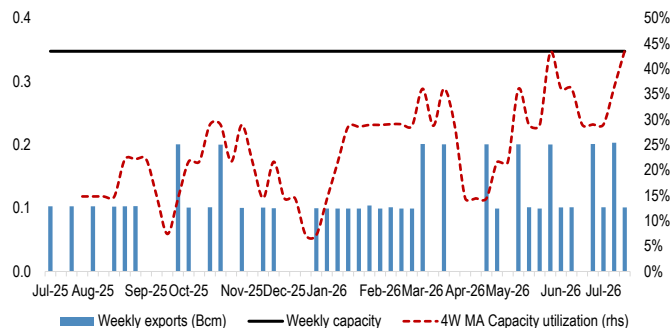
Mcm/day, 4w MA



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 18: Arctic LNG 2 weekly exports and capacity utilisation

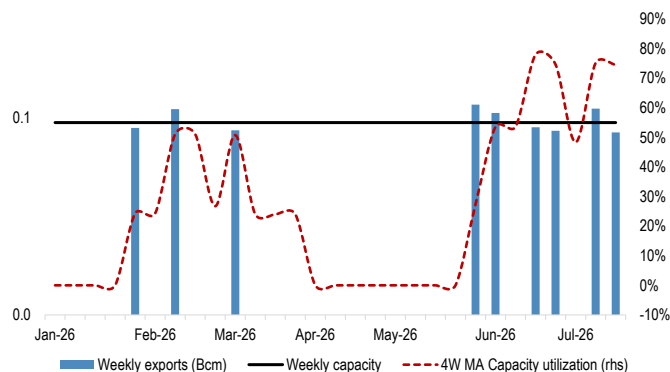
LHS: Bcm, RHS: %



Assumed capacity 6.6mtpa (9 Bcm/year) per train, 2 trains in operation
Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 20: Darwin weekly exports and capacity utilisation

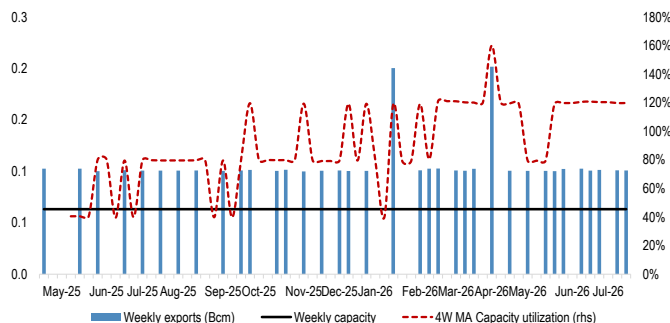
LHS: Bcm, RHS: %



Assumed capacity 3.7mtpa (5.1 Bcm/year)
Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 22: Tortue LNG weekly exports and capacity utilisation

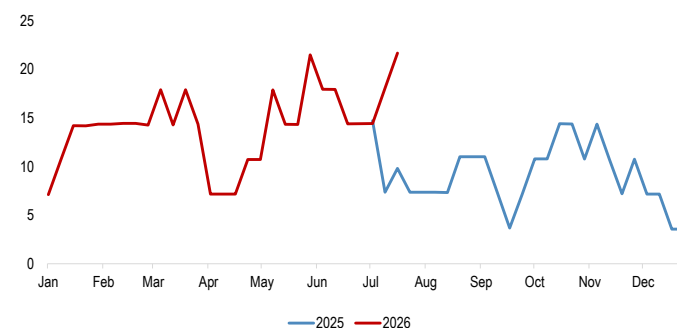
LHS: Bcm, RHS: %



Assumed capacity 2.4 mtpa (3.3 Bcm/year)
Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 19: Arctic 2 seasonal exports

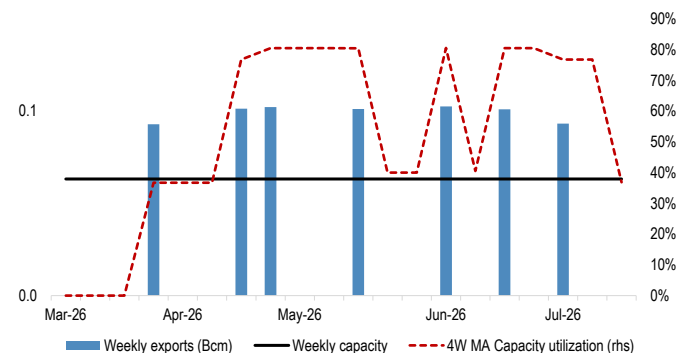
Mcm/day, 4w MA



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 21: Congo weekly exports and capacity utilisation

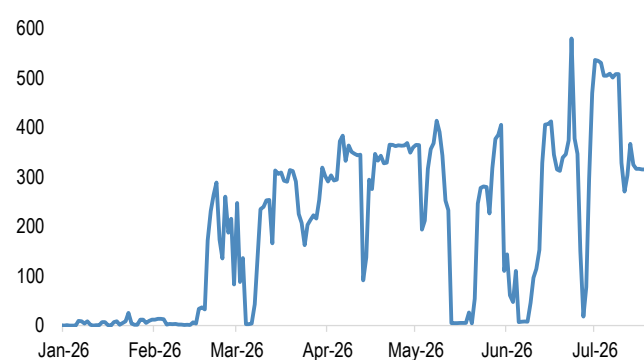
LHS: Bcm, RHS: %



Assumed capacity 2.4mtpa (3.3 Bcm/year)
Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 23: Golden Pass feedgas flows

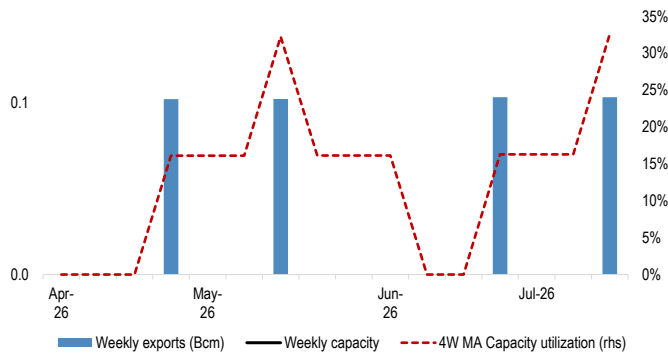
MMcf/day



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Figure 24: Golden Pass weekly exports and capacity utilisation

LHS: Bcm, RHS: %



Assumed capacity 6 mtpa (8.3 Bcm/year)
Source: Company Data, Wood Mackenzie, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan Commodities Research

Latest Research

Related research on the impact of Middle East conflict on global LNG markets

[Global LNG Supply Shipping Tracker: Qatar's ramp-up under spotlight again](#), 13 Jul 2026

Iran-US tensions escalated sharply after Iranian strikes on Qatar LNG and Saudi oil tankers in Hormuz on July 7, triggering a US sanctions step-up and renewed military action that threatens the mid-June MOU and disrupts shipping. Ahead of the latest escalation, Qatar had accelerated restart activity. It arranged for a number of empty vessels to return to Ras Laffan for future loadings and also increased actual loadings. However, Hormuz exits have stalled and QatarEnergy is reportedly pausing ramp-up, raising winter supply-delay risk that could require a higher risk premium – especially with Europe's low storage and fewer US LNG cargoes heading to Europe.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Asia leads, Europe to catch up](#), 7 Jul 2026

Alternative LNG supplies have offset almost two-thirds of the lost Qatar/UAE volumes over the past four months (led by the US/ North America). However, much of that incremental supply went to Asia due to elevated regional price spreads, leaving Europe with tight on-the-ground fundamentals and rising weather-related uncertainty. At the same time, growth in alternative supply is set to moderate, while Qatar's ramp up is taking time, as expected. The result is a materially weaker European storage trajectory, structurally tight 3Q balances, and significant risks into 4Q and winter.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Another explosion at Ras Laffan](#), 22 Jun 2026

Qatar Energy reported an explosion and fire at the Barzan gas facility in Ras Laffan Industrial City during start-up operations, resulting in 13 fatalities and 66 injuries. The Barzan plant, which processes gas mainly for Qatar's domestic market, was not expected to impact LNG exports, as confirmed by the CEO, since the direct effect on LNG infrastructure was limited – unlike a previous incident caused by Iranian attacks. We estimate that Qatar's liquefaction capacity is running at about 17% utilization on a seven-day moving-average basis, based on actual loadings from Bloomberg ship-tracking data. This is above our earlier run-rate forecasts for this point in the ramp-up, assuming the process began on Memorial Day. This, however, brings us back to the importance of "Day 0". If restart operations began in early May, the observed ramp-up pace would be lagging well behind our forecasts. Given the inherent uncertainty in these estimates and the still relatively early stage of the ramp-up, we prefer to continue monitoring progress rather than revise our assumptions at this time.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: The first swallow](#), 15 Jun 2026

Following the announced ceasefire agreement between the US and Iran, the first LNG tanker exited the Strait with transponders on. Based on Bloomberg ship tracking data, we estimate Disha was loaded in Ras Laffan on June 12-13 and exited Hormuz in the early hours of June 15, heading to Dahej, India. After the Disha exit, we count just eight vessels inside the Strait, two of which currently have their transponders switched off and either may, in practice, already be outside the Strait. Following a potential full reopening of the Strait later this week, we maintain our view that it will take 2-3 months for LNG exports from the region to reach normalized levels. We continue to model Qatar Energy gradually ramping up to 83% utilization by September and continue to assess 3Q balances as tight with significant price upside towards our forecasted level of 55 EUR/MWh.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Open, or not open, that is the question](#), 12 Jun 2026

Since Memorial Day, oil tanker traffic through the Strait of Hormuz has increased, with volumes rising from 2.9 mbd in May to 5.1 mbd in June, helping offset global oil market shortfalls. In contrast, LNG shipping remains minimal, with only 17 vessels stranded at the conflict's onset and just nine observed crossings since March, highlighting the limited impact of LNG transits on market rebalancing. While occasional exits and intra-Gulf deliveries suggest some flexibility, LNG volumes are negligible compared to oil, and market balance remains largely unchanged until Qatari LNG facilities resume operations, which is expected to ramp up gradually through September.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: First LNG tanker enters the Strait.](#) 08 June 2026

ADNOC's Mubarak – the first laden LNG vessel to leave the Strait of Hormuz on April 2 – re-entered the Strait on June 3 and is now signalling near Das Island, likely loading cargo, while QatarEnergy managed one additional export out of Hormuz as Al Daayen exited on June 8 bound for China. Following the two observed crossings, we count nine available LNG vessels inside the Strait of Hormuz. We continue to treat sporadic transits as exceptions rather than a new norm until Hormuz fully reopens, with the finite pool of vessels currently inside the strait naturally capping the volume of ready-to-ship cargoes. Additional LNG volumes beyond the currently available cargoes will depend on restarting upstream production, liquefaction, and normal port operations. Consistent with our base case for a June reopening, we model Qatar Energy ramping to 83% utilisation by September, implying a full-year 2026 utilisation rate of 57% – down sharply from 105% in 2025. Since the onset of the conflict, we have argued restarting undamaged Qatari LNG trains is expected to take at least 2-3 months due to operational, security, and strategic constraints (excluding the two damaged trains). This view aligns closely with QatarEnergy's messaging and the CEO's comments.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: The rebalancing.](#) 01 June 2026

Over the past three months, the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has caused major disruptions to global seaborne oil and gas flows, leading to a sharp decline in Qatari and UAE LNG exports by 300 Mcm/day year-over-year (-95%). Despite this supply shock, global spot LNG prices have remained relatively stable, elevated above pre-conflict levels but well below the peaks of the 2022 energy crisis. The lost Middle Eastern volumes have been largely offset by increased exports from new projects in the US and North America, as well as contributions from Africa, Malaysia, Norway, and Russia. This supply response has limited upward pressure on LNG prices, with Asian markets absorbing most of the demand adjustment and European imports declining. However, European gas storage levels have suffered, falling to 30% compared to the historical average of 56%, as net injections slowed. The flexibility of the global LNG market is now nearing its limits, with incremental supply growth fading and Asian demand declines stabilizing. Looking ahead, as the European peak injection season approaches, we continue to expect prices to move higher from current levels to achieve two objectives that would eventually support the European storage trajectory: a further acceleration of gas-to-coal switching in the European power sector, and a softening of the Asian spot LNG pull, particularly as the region moves into the summer cooling season.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Australia strikes again.](#) 26 May 2026

Australia's LNG plants are facing threats of strikes and the three plants at risk have a combined capacity of 44 Bcm/year, equivalent to 35% of Australia's total LNG liquefaction capacity. Despite such a significant supply disruption at risk, markets appear to be discounting the impact and are instead focusing on developments around the Strait of Hormuz and prospects of Qatari (and UAE) LNG supply. However, it is worth remembering the summer of 2023, when similar risks of strikes pushed European natural gas prices from about 27 EUR/MWh at the end of July to about 45 EUR/MWh by late August. Eventually, back in 2023, the unions and LNG plant operators found a middle ground, strikes were avoided and no volumes to global LNG markets were lost. The situation remains evolving with no clear goalposts but clear (limited so far) impacts.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Initiating JKM forecasts with a declining premium to TTF.](#) 19 May 2026

Mounting pressure on global oil inventories is expected to drive a re-opening of the Strait of Hormuz in June, enabling Qatar exports to reach ~83% utilisation by September and adding ~15 Bcm of LNG supply during Europe's injection season, about two extra months versus prior assumptions. With quarter-to-date realised prices around €45/MWh, we trim our TTF outlook by ~€5/MWh through 1Q27 (still above the futures curve) and introduce JKM forecasts at a declining premium to TTF – narrowing from ~\$2/MMBtu QTD to ~\$0.5/MMBtu in late 2Q/3Q – supporting Europe as a more profitable destination for USGC spot exports. Qatar's return alongside the potential start of NFE Train 1 will drive roughly half of the projected 60 Bcm increase in global LNG supply in 2027. Other near-term supply additions include Golden Pass (5-6 Bcm in 2026-27), Australia's Pluto expansion (up to 5 Bcm in 2027), and CP2 (40 Bcm/year capacity, starting September 2027). A more significant supply wave of 90-100 Bcm/year is expected in 2028-29 as multiple US projects ramp up alongside further Qatari expansion and developments in Argentina, Nigeria, and elsewhere.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: First Qatari cargo exits Hormuz](#), 11 May 2026

Qatar has dispatched its first LNG cargo to Pakistan since the conflict began, with the vessel Al Kharaitiyat having exited the Strait of Hormuz on May 9, reportedly authorised by Iran under a government deal to rebuild confidence. A second vessel, the Chinese-owned Mihzem, also appears headed to Pakistan's Port Qasim. The deliveries are likely under long-term contracts between QatarEnergy and Pakistan State Oil at oil-linked prices (10-13% slope), offering a significant discount to prevailing spot rates. However, these volumes do not meaningfully ease global LNG tightness, and with only 14 LNG vessels remaining in the Persian Gulf and ballast vessels unlikely to enter the Strait for loading, ready-to-ship capacity remains limited for when traffic normalises. Meanwhile, although US LNG remains more attractive to Asian buyers with TTF netbacks discounted to JKM, US maintenance season has pulled Asia-bound shipments down from over 200 Mcm/day to around 175 Mcm/day over the past week.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Asia pulls even more US cargoes as JKM premium widens](#), 5 May 2026

Despite higher global LNG prices during the week, the discount of TTF netbacks compared to JKM has widened over the week. Accordingly, US-origin spot LNG cargoes remain more profitable towards Asian destinations. We estimate that the US LNG facilities loaded about 3.3 Bcm of LNG during the last week, of which only 57% appears to be en route towards European (and Mediterranean) destinations. Meanwhile, on 56th day of the conflict, the second LNG crossing of the Strait took place. The ADNOC-owned Mubaraz, which has been off the radar since late March, re-appeared near Indian shore on April 27, passed through Strait of Malacca on May 3 and is en route to deliver first such cargo to China. This marks the first laden LNG vessel crossing of the Strait of Hormuz since the start of operation "Epic Fury" on February 28 and an effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Kuwait on track for 8th cargo, as US LNG goes to Asia](#), 27 April 2026

Immediately following the start of the conflict in the Middle East and the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz, Asia attracted about 100 Mcm/day of LNG that originated in the US Gulf Coast, with Europe effectively giving up the corresponding amount. This trend reversed in the first half of April as European-bound loadings recovered, however over the last 10 days or so Asia has again emerged as the primary destination for the US (primarily spot) cargoes. This dynamic is consistent with near-term JKM and TTF price signals, which continue to imply superior netbacks for Asian destinations. Prices remain the most powerful market mechanism, and we expect them to rise from late 2Q into 3Q, accelerating European storage injections toward the 80% level by November 1.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Again on Qatari restarts](#), 21 April 2026

Qatar appears to have begun limited liquefaction restarts at its undamaged QatarGas (North) facilities, with steady exports to Kuwait (7 cargos since March 23) suggesting some active production rather than purely storage drawdowns – though only Trains 1-3 are believed operational, representing just ~13% of total capacity and likely running below full capacity. However, as we have argued from the onset of the conflict, it's not the speed of restart but the pace of ramp-up that will dictate LNG availability this summer. With limited progress and visibility on RasGas (South) facilities, the pace remains uncertain and likely still aligned with our 2-3 month timeline. However, a faster-than-anticipated ramp up could meaningfully alter summer balances with up to 4 Bcm of variance in output – potentially putting downward pressure on global LNG prices.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Did Qatar start the restarts?](#), 19 April 2026

The steady loading pattern at Ras Laffan raises the question of whether Qatar has resumed liquefaction or is still drawing from onshore storage tanks. Qatar Energy has not officially announced any restart of operations, however, unconfirmed press reports last week have stated the company has restarted 2 trains at Qatargas. We retain our base case of a 2-3 month restart timeline; however, what matters is when the day count begins – and where we currently stand in the timeline.

[Global LNG Analyzer: All eyes on new/alternative supply: spotlight on Qatar restart timeline](#), 13 April 2026

In the month of March, global LNG imports were 49.5 Bcm, or about 5% lower year-over-year and 13% lower month-over-month. The decline was steepest in Japan and South Korea, where imports declined by 15% MoM, followed by -10% in the rest

of Asia (ex. China). The 300 Mcm/day decline YoY in exports from Qatar/UAE was partially offset by increased output from new projects in the US, Canada and Africa. As we have noted repeatedly, global LNG supply was set to increase by about 50 Bcm in 2026, about 75% of which was to come from projects that are already operational, led by projects like Plaquemines, Corpus Christi LNG Stage 3 and LNG Canada. In this edition of Global LNG Analyzer, we also spotlight Qatar's LNG restart timeline and reiterate our expectation of 2-3 month restart period following the end of hostilities.

[European Natural Gas: Solving for 80%, 7 April 2026](#)

Northwest Europe exited winter with storage at 18% full – the second lowest level on record (excluding 2018). To reach 80% ahead of next winter, in line with last year and consistent with the EU's amended '90% minus 10%' flexibility target, NWE/EU will need to inject 31/56 Bcm over Apr-Oct, about 5 Bcm more than last year. These injection needs are likely to be met via a mix of gas-to-coal switching, higher Norwegian supply, and stronger LNG imports. In the global LNG, incremental supply from other sources could offset up to half of the lost Qatari/UAE volumes; the remainder would need to be absorbed through demand adjustment. To accelerate already started LNG demand destruction in Asia and for Europe to fill storages, prices will need to move higher. We revise our Q2/Q3/Q4 2026 prices to 55/60/65 EUR/MWh, expecting LNG competition to intensify in Q3 as European storage demand overlaps with potential Asian cooling demand.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Oman-managed \(ballast\) LNG ship exits the strait, 6 April 2026](#)

On the 33rd day since the start of the operation "Epic Fury" we observed the first LNG vessel transiting via the Strait of Hormuz. Sohar LNG, which appears to be on ballast at the time of the crossing, is co-owned by Japan's Mitsui OSK and managed by Oman Ship Management Co. The vessel left the strait with two oil tankers also managed by Oman Ship Management Company, and is now on its way towards Oman LNG export facility. This might well indicate some understanding between Iran and Oman to "co-manage" the Strait, but as we have argued since the onset of the conflict, as long as the Qatari LNG facilities remain shut, such occasional transits or even deliveries do not really change the state of the global LNG market. Following the exit of Sohar LNG from the gulf, we now count 16 LNG vessels remaining in the Persian Gulf.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: Kuwait imports Qatari cargoes, 30 March 2026](#)

Almost a month into the major conflict in the Middle East, the the Strait of Hormuz remains firmly shut for any LNG transit; however, last week marked the first successful LNG import in the region, from Qatar to Kuwait. We believe these shipments remain isolated from the wider global LNG market, as there are still the same 17 vessels that were within the Persian Gulf at the start of the regional conflict.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Flash Note: Iran-Türkiye pipeline flows stopped, 24 March 2026](#)

Following Israel's strike on Iran's South Pars field last week (the largest gas field in the world and the backbone of the Iranian natural gas industry), press reports indicate that Iranian gas exports to Türkiye have now stopped. Iran exported about 8.2 Bcm to Türkiye in 2025, down from a peak of 9.4 Bcm/year in 2021–22. The latest datapoint (as of January) shows imports of only 4 Mcm/day, well below seasonal norms. The news triggered a €1.5/MWh intraday rise in TTF front-month prices. This relatively modest move is consistent with our expectations outlined in prior research: Ankara would likely offset any potential disruption in Iranian flows through increased Russian pipeline gas supplies, with relatively limited pressure on the global LNG market. Using 2025 as a guide, we expect sufficient spare capacity on Russia-Türkiye pipelines – especially TurkStream 1 – to fully offset the loss of Iranian supplies.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: European imports recover, 22 March 2026](#)

European LNG imports recovered in the week of Mar 15–21 (+0.6 Bcm week-on-week, led by U.S. LNG arrivals into Spain), alongside increased deliveries to China (+0.6 Bcm, mainly from Australia) and Egypt (+0.4 Bcm). Deliveries declined in all other major importing regions, led by a decline in Japan/Korea (-0.8 Bcm WoW). We believe Qatar loaded a cargo on March 18, just before the Iranian attacks on Ras Laffan. The tanker Gasslog Skagen currently appears to be en route to Kuwait. If unloaded, this would mark the first LNG delivery in the region since the start of the conflict.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Flash Note: Thoughts on Ras Laffan 2.0, 19 March 2026](#)

As we incorporate details on physical damage at Ras Laffan, we reduce the normalized capacity utilization rate from 90% to 80% as the two damaged trains will take 3-5 years to repair, according to the comments by Qatar Energy CEO. We also lower the ramp-up speed and now estimate lost Qatari supply during the summer (March–October) at 36 Bcm (compared to 30 Bcm previously) if the Strait re-opens in one month after the conflict, with an additional 7 Bcm/month at risk for each additional month of delay.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Flash Note: Thoughts on Ras Laffan, 19 March 2026](#)

Qatar Energy confirmed that in the early hours of March 19 its LNG facilities came under attack “causing sizeable fires and extensive further damage”. We expect this to reinforce QatarEnergy’s cautious approach that we have highlighted since the force majeure. Qatar’s export resumption and its expansion plans will be guided by a set of logistical, safety, and strategic factors – not just operational or commercial considerations. Ras Laffan Industrial City is a massive complex with an area of about 300km² (115sq. mi), or about five times the size of Manhattan. In addition to the LNG facilities, it hosts a wide array of other industrial sites, including refineries, petrochemicals, desalination and power plants, as well as civilian infrastructure such as medical centres and workers’ accommodation.

[Global LNG Flash Note: The Chinese \(and Indian\) exception, 16 March 2026](#)

Following reports of limited transits by Chinese ships through the Strait of Hormuz – and the departure of two Indian-flagged LPG tankers –reports emerge that Iran may allow Chinese and Indian tankers to sail through the waterway. Can such an arrangement materially ease the disruption to LNG supply via the Strait? Short answer: no. Of the 17 LNG vessels currently in the Persian Gulf, only two are owned by Chinese companies; at least one is not loaded, and both are insured in the UK. While some tankers might be allowed to exit the Strait and deliver cargoes to end markets, this would not materially change the situation as long as Qatar’s liquefaction facilities remain shut.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: More US cargoes heading towards Asia, 15 March, 2026](#)

Following the launch of Operation Epic Fury by the US and Israel on February 28, no LNG vessel has transited through the Strait of Hormuz in either direction, ballast or laden. There are still the same 17 vessels that were within the Persian Gulf at the start of the regional conflict, most of them already loaded and used as floating storage, with no draft changes observed for any of them during the week. In line with increased US loadings, cargo diversions, and rising Asian imports, we note a marginal uptick in LNG vessels routing via the Cape of Good Hope, likely driven by US-origin cargoes bound for Asia.

[Global LNG Analyzer: Rise of the spot, 12 March 2026](#)

Qatar’s export resumption and its expansion plans will be guided by a set of logistical, safety, and strategic factors – not just operational or commercial considerations. With 2029/30 TTF prices up only €1-1.3/MWh since the start of the conflict, the market still prices in a medium-term oversupply, which we believe warrants a reconsideration. Force majeure and ongoing disruptions will prompt major LNG buyers to increase their spot presence this summer, with South Korea/Taiwan in Asia, and NWE/Italy in Europe, being the most exposed. We still see €60-70/MWh as a fair summer price under persistent disruption, while winter prices will depend on hard-to-predict variables – weather and the reliability/confidence in existing/new supply (esp. Qatar).

[Global LNG Analyzer: Who is most affected and is there an alternative supply? 9 March 2026](#)

In the last twelve months (Mar 2025 to Feb 2026), we estimate that Qatar and the UAE exported 115.5 Bcm of LNG, of which 108.4 Bcm exited the Strait of Hormuz, with the remainder delivered within the Gulf to the UAE (Dubai), Kuwait, and Bahrain. China accounted for 24% of the exported volumes, India for 17%, followed by Taiwan, Pakistan, and South Korea (8%-9% each). Imports via Hormuz represented 29% of China’s total LNG imports and 56% of India’s total LNG imports, and accounted for almost 100% and 67% of LNG imports in Pakistan and Bangladesh, respectively.

[Global LNG Supply & Shipping Tracker: First reaction to supply shock—more to Asia, less to Europe](#), 8 March 2026

Following the launch of Operation Epic Fury by the US and Israel on February 28, LNG vessel transit through the Strait of Hormuz effectively ceased immediately. This marks a significant event in the global LNG and energy markets, as the Strait has never been closed and remained operational even during past conflicts. Initial market reaction was Asian LNG prices rising higher than European benchmarks, leading to the redirection of cargoes from Europe to Asia. Overall in the first week of the conflict, global LNG deliveries declined by 2.6 Bcm week-over-week. Outside of Europe, Turkey and Egypt also saw declines, likely due to security and shipping concerns in the region.

[Global LNG Flash Note: First thoughts on demand destruction](#), 5 March 2026

Despite tentative signs of de-escalation in the conflict and US government efforts to re-open the Strait of Hormuz, restoring LNG flows may take longer than initially thought. Restoring Qatari exports to pre-conflict levels is not a function of operational limits, it's a function of complex security, logistical and strategic considerations. In a scenario of prolonged disruptions, demand destruction appears to be the near-term market response. The most price-sensitive Asian buyers will take the biggest hit, followed by China and gas-to-coal switch in Europe, with JKM power demand setting the "fair value" of demand destruction. Global coal stockpiles are at much healthier levels compared to 2022 (China at 8x), potentially limiting significant price spikes in natural gas markets.

[Global LNG Flash Note: Market on the brink of a major reset](#), 3 March 2026

The potential impact from prolonged regional disruptions in the Middle East is up to 150 Bcm/year (23%) of the global LNG market – elephant in the room is the currently suspended Qatari LNG exports. The duration of the disruption will ultimately define the fundamental impact and the actual amount of molecules lost; unlike 2022 this supply shock is abrupt and largely unexpected. In case of prolonged disruption, the only viable alternative supply source is Russian gas, which can provide up to 80 Bcm/year to European and global markets if certain (difficult) preconditions are met. Otherwise, the market will likely need to balance via significantly higher demand-destruction prices.

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